

ACIBADEM UNIVERSITY
Statement of Support for Tarik Ziya Aykut

Date: June 1, 2026

To Whom It May Concern,

I am pleased to provide this statement in support of Tarik Ziya Aykut's graduate study applications. Tarik has been an active and visible contributor to student life at Acibadem University, particularly through his work in debate, student leadership, public speaking, and cultural activities.

To the best of my knowledge, Tarik served as Team Captain of the Acibadem University Debate Society during the 2022-2023 academic year, and later served as President of the society during the 2023-2024 and 2025-2026 academic years. In these roles, he contributed not only as a competitor, but also as an organizer, mentor, and student leader.

As part of his debate society work, Tarik regularly supported free training sessions for university students, including sessions held on Tuesdays and Thursdays. These trainings covered a broad range of topics such as economics, international relations, argumentation, rebuttal techniques, social policy, and feminism. Through these activities, he helped students develop analytical thinking, structured argumentation, public speaking, and respectful discussion skills.

Tarik also represented Acibadem University in many debate tournaments across Turkey. He took part in competitive rounds, reached finals, and achieved championship results. In addition to competing, he contributed to the organization of several tournaments hosted by Acibadem University, taking responsibility for planning, coordination, and event execution. He also served as an adjudicator in high school debate tournaments attended by some of Turkey's leading high schools, thereby contributing to debate education beyond the university level.

One of his notable contributions was his involvement in the Oxford-Arg.ist debate tournament hosted at Acibadem University. Tarik supported the organization of the event and also served as an adjudicator, contributing to English-language debate and international academic engagement on campus.

Beyond debate, Tarik was also among the founding members of AcuHarmony Music Club. He contributed to the development of the club and performed in multiple university events, showing his willingness to take part in cultural life and collaborative student initiatives.

Overall, Tarik has demonstrated strong leadership, communication skills, responsibility, and commitment to university life. His extracurricular record shows that he is not only technically and academically motivated, but also capable of mentoring others, organizing complex events, representing his university, and contributing to a wider student community.

I believe these qualities will support his success in an international graduate environment, where communication, initiative, teamwork, and intellectual curiosity are highly valuable.

Sincerely,

Prof. Dr. İrfan Güney

Vice Rector

Acibadem University